

Licensure Examination for Teachers (LET) Review
Focus: Philosophy and Logic

Content Update

I. Philosophy

- Etymologically, philosophy comes from two Greek words, *philia* which means "to love" and *sophia* which means "wisdom".
- Traditionally defined as the science of all things studied from the viewpoint of their ultimate causes under the light of human reason alone.
- The study of the truths or principles underlying all knowledge, being and reality, including values, meanings, and purposes of human life.

Division of Philosophy

1. **Epistemology** - literally means "the study and nature of knowledge". It deal with questions of knowledge (including the structure, reliability, extent and kinds of knowledge); truth, validity, and logic; and a variety of linguistic concerns (e.g. the question of whether truth is relative).
2. **Metaphysics** - addresses questions of reality (including the meaning and nature of being); the nature of mind, self, and human freedom; and some topics that overlap with religion, such as the existence of God, the destiny of the universe and the immortality of the soul (e.g. question of whether human behavior is free or determined).
3. **Axiology**- the area of Philosophy that specifically deals with the problem of human values
4. **Ethics** - study of values and moral principles and how they relate to human conduct to our social and political institutions (e.g. question of whether human beings have the moral obligation to love and serve others, or only obligation to themselves). A standard for calling a human act right or wrong; good or evil. The practical and philosophical science of morality, of human acts, or human conduct. Came from the word *ethics* which means the doctrine of morality
5. **Logic**-the systematic treatment of relationship of ideas
6. **Cosmology**- theories of the nature and origin of the universe
7. **Philosophy of Man/ Philosophy of human person**-deals with the nature and purpose of man
8. **Social and Political Philosophy**- deals with the nature of society and socialization process.
9. **Theodicy**- the study of the nature, essence and existence of God using human reason
10. **Aesthetics**- the study of the nature and appreciation of beauty

Classical Philosophy

A. What is Idealism?

- Meaning is in the ideals of life itself
- Reality is made up of absolute truths
- Educationally, this means the use of inductive reasoning, lecturing
- Plato was an early key proponent of this model
- Truth or reality exists in ideas or in the spirit or mind
- Material objects are mere representations of idea
- Will governs our conduct
- Judges behavior in terms of motives (not in results)
- Knowledge is obtained thru speculation and reasoning
- Society is organism in individuals participate
- Selfhood is attained thru social processes
- With society providing the matrix for the development of the individual, the individual progresses, then attaining self-realization
- At the same time, society develops in a process of realizing the good society

B. What is Naturalism?

- Denies anything as having supernaturality
- Concepts are formed from the physical universe
- Human being is just only transitory product of physical processes
- Thus human and society are dependent upon nature
- Society as aspect/part of nature [not so much of organism]
- Individual is nature's offspring [not a child of society]
- Though individual is dependent on nature

C. What is Realism?

- Universe as composed of beings existing independently but related and forming a hierarchical structure (cosmos/totality)
- Meaning comes through empirically proven facts
- Reality is made up of natural laws, facts
- However, empirical facts are always subject to change
- Educationally this involves scientific reasoning

- But human nature is not achieved by virtues alone
- Human nature aims to achieve the ultimate goal (happiness) by transcending self-realization [self is fulfilled with others]
- Aristotle asserts that individual is part of the whole
- Anyone who is not part of society is like a beast or a god (not a human)
- Society is the external support to man's fulfillment
- Thus, state as an organized society has a moral purpose of maintaining order and exercising justice for the common good

D. What is Liberalism?

- Aims at the development of individual freedom
- Society is one which individuals are left free to pursue their own interest and fulfillment
- There is restraint imposed in order to keep individuals from harming others
- Liberalism believes that human being having rational intellect, have the ability to recognize problems and solve them, thus achieving improvement in society
- Opposite of liberalism is conservatism (supports the maintenance of status quo)

E. What is Humanism?

- Intellect distinguishes humans from animals
- Humans have potential/innate goodness
- Thus, educationally you facilitate and encourage self-direction
- Some educational needs may be missed?
- Abraham Maslow early proponent

Modern Philosophy

A. What is Positivism?

- Based primarily on science, Auguste Comte was the first to use the term when he developed his philosophical idea of laws of societal growth
- Three ascending stages
 - theological stage – explains natural phenomena by involving spiritual being
 - metaphysical stage – depersonalizes these beings into forces and essences
 - positive stage – relies mainly on sciences
- One's duties to society and humanity prevails over individual interests
- Development of society is based on sciences, technology, industry
- But it should be accompanied by moral regeneration (welfare of society is more important than private interests)

B. What is Communism?

- It is not the consciousness of man that determines their beings, but rather it is their social being that determines their consciousness
- He viewed history as a history of class struggles (between capitalist class and proletariat)
- There is exploitation, oppression, marginalization and alienation among the working class because of the capitalist system
- There is a connection between the economic aspect of social life to other aspects (education, religion, laws, etc)
- Marx claims that capitalism will dig its own graveyard. Capitalism will continue to develop to the point of extreme exploitation
- The result is social revolution which will be initiated by the working class
- The dominant ideas are the ideas of the ruling class (elite)

C. What is Fascism?

- Adolf Hitler (Nazi Germany); Benito Mussolini (Italian Dictator)
- Totalitarian philosophy of government that heightened national belonging
- It rejects liberal ideas like freedom, liberty
- Presses the destruction of election, legislatures, other democratic institutions
- Glorification of the state. Total subordination of individual to the state. The state has absolute power
- Survival of the fittest. Complacency is doomed. Aggressive militarism is a leading character of fascist state (leads to imperialism)
- Elitism – the dictator embodies the ideals of the nation. The leader as superman.

D. What is Existentialism?

- Philosophy of subjectivity or selfhood whose fundamental doctrine proclaims man's freedom in the accomplishment of his destiny
- Human existence was marked off from other kinds of man's power to choose.
- The decision we make will make us the kind of person that is distinct totally from every other person.
- Thus every value is dependent upon the free choice of every man

E. What is Pragmatism?

- Contribution of American philosophy (John Dewey, William James, Charles Peirce)
- Theory that the processes and the materials of knowledge are determined by practical consideration
- It is supported experimental sciences (laboratory method) – hypotheses are ideas or proposed solutions to problems
- Truth is which that works, solves the problems
- Pragmatist focus on the consequences and how they are controlled thru intelligence is the foundation of their concepts of person and society

- Person is a social animal (associational being)
- For pragmatist, a person is a problem solver in a plural environment

Eastern Philosophy

A. What is Hinduism?

Hinduism - a worldwide religious tradition rooted in Indian culture and based on teachings of the Vedas. It is the major religion of India, accounting for 85% of the population. It has known as "Trimurti" which consists of BRAHMA, the supreme spirit, VISHNU, the preserver, and SHIVA, the destroyer and creator.

1. What are social classes of Hindu known as caste system?

- Brahmins/Brahmans - the priests
- Kshatriyas - the nobles and the warriors
- Vaisyas - the traders, cultivators, peasants
- Sudras - the servants (Outside the caste system are the untouchables or outcasts)

The Hindu's life is governed by the law of "karma" which is a process or series of birth and rebirth until one attains perfection and finally reaches "nirvana" - the place of eternal happiness and bliss. Under this belief, the sum of the person's actions carried from one life to the next results in either an improved or worsened fate.

2. What are four main collections of Vedas (sacred text)?

- Rig Veda - hymns and praises
- Yajur Veda -prayer and sacrificial formulas
- Sama Veda - tunes and chants
- Atharva Veda - magical formulas

B. What is Buddhism?

Buddhism - one of the major religions of the world; founded by Siddharta Gautama, the Buddha, who lived in Northern India.

1. What are the Two Major Division of Buddhism?

1. Theravada or "Way of the Elders" (the more conservative type), popular in Sri Lanka, Burma, and Thailand
2. Mahayana or "Great Vehicle" (liberal type), dominant in Taiwan, Korea, Japan, and Tibet

2. What are the four noble truths advocated by Buddha?

- Life is suffering (duhka);
- The cause of suffering is desire;
- The end of suffering is to stop desire; and
- To stop desire is to follow the Noble Eight-fold Path (to break the chain of karma and to reach Nirvana)

3. What are the Noble Eight-fold Path?

- Right View
- Right Resolve
- Right Speech
- Right Action
- Right Livelihood
- Right Effort
- Right Concentration
- Right Contemplation

C. What is Confucianism?

Confucianism - an East Asian school of ethical, philosophical, and religious thought originally developed from the teachings of the early Chinese sage Confucius (551 - 479 B.C.E.).

1. What are the Key Concepts in Confucian thoughts?

- Rites (ritual, sacrifice or social etiquette)
- Humaneness (The Golden Rule)
- The Perfect Gentleman/Exemplary Person ("son of a ruler," "prince," or "noble," the ideal of a "gentleman")
- Proper governance ("government by virtue")
- Meritocracy
- Filial Piety (respect and obedience that a son should show to his parents)
- Loyalty (moral commitments to one's surrounding social, cultural, and historical community as a whole)
- Rectification of names

D. What is Shintoism

Shintoism - popular during the Imperial regime but lost its popularity when Japan lost during the Second World War. Shinto was not a Japanese word. It was derived from the Chinese "shon" (Gods) and "tao" (the way). The intention was to distinguish this religion from Buddhism when it first entered Japan.

Shintoism - belief in the "kami no michi" or the "way of the kami". Kami are Japanese deities or goods of nature like the sun goddess, Katerasu, whom the Japanese believed that the Imperial family came from. During the Imperial reign, Japan is said to be a theocratic state.

II. The Nature and Meaning of Logic

- Logic is the science and the art of correct thinking
- Logic is the study of inferential thinking and methods and processes to arrive at principles for distinguishing correct from incorrect arguments.

- Logic is the study of relationships of ideas and judgments that results into a discovery of new ideas and judgments
- Logic is the study of the mental operation by which the mind discovers new truths from the relationships of known truths.
- Logic is the study of right reasoning and good thinking. It is an important tool in critical, strategic and creative thinking.

Correct Reasoning or Inference: End Task in Logic

- Reasoning is the thinking process by which a conclusion is inferred from the relationship or implication of premise/s
- Argument is a set of statements related to infer a conclusion. It is the product of reasoning
- Syllogism is the verbal expression of an argument
- Validity of Inference refers to the sequence of the thinking process in such a way that the conclusion was derived from the relationship of the premise/s
- Formal Validity means that the inference followed the established structure or form of reasoning
- Material Validity refers to the truthfulness of the content or meaning of the reasoning process
- Soundness refers to the reasoning process that is both valid and true
- Truth refers to the agreement between reality and what is in the mind

Three Mental Operations: The key to Correct Inferential Thinking

Mental Operation	Product	External Manifestation
1. Simple Apprehension	Concepts/Ideas	Terms
2. Judgment	Mental Statements	Propositions
3. Reasoning	Arguments	Syllogisms

1. Simple Apprehension: The First Mental Operation

- Simple apprehension is the process of grasping or abstracting the essence of a thing without affirming or denying anything about it.
- It involves the awareness of the presence of certain reality which is the object of human knowledge
- It results into an idea or concept-the abstracted nature of the reality that was experienced. This idea or concept is verbally manifested through terms- the stuff we use to communicate and share our ideas, feelings and emotions

2. Judgment: The second Mental Operation

- Since the external world is made up of realities that are interrelated, it cannot be understood comprehensively by a single idea or in one single apprehensive act. And so the mind proceeds, after knowing different ideas, by recognizing the relationships or non-relationship between and among these ideas through judgment.
- Judgment is a mental operation that pronounces the agreement or disagreement between two ideas.
- It is the process of establishing the relationships between ideas with another in order to understand comprehensively the nature of realities.
- The real unity of things in the external world is reflected in the logical union of different ideas in judgment.
- Judgment results into a mental statement of relationship or non-relationship of two ideas. This statement is called mental propositions. This in turn is externally manifested through an oral or written proposition or a logical sentence.

3. Reasoning: The Third Mental Operation

- Reasoning is a mental act whereby the mind infers a new judgment that necessarily follows from the relationship of several judgments.
- It is the process of drawing new truths from the relationships of known truths.
- The known truths that are interrelated to result into a new truth are called premises while the resulting truth is called the conclusion.
- Reasoning results into a mental argument or inference. This mental argument is externally expressed through syllogism.
- The final result of reasoning is the discovery of a new truth implied by the relationship of the two known truths. Thus a human being is afforded knowledge of something, which he may not actually and physically experience through reasoning.

CATERGORICAL PROPOSITION

- A proposition that gives direct assertion of agreement and disagreement between the subject term and the predicate term.
- Four Elements
 1. quantifier
 2. subject term
 3. predicate term
 4. copula
 1. Quantifier – indicates the degree of universality(quantity) of the subject.
 - a. universal quantifier – all, every, any, no, none
 - b. particular quantifier – some, at least one, most, almost all, the majority.
 2. Subject Term – is that which something is affirmed or denied
 3. Predicate Term – is that which is affirmed or denied of the subject term.
 4. Copula – is the linking verb is (am, are, was, were), and is not (am not, are not, was, were not) indicating agreement and disagreement between the subject and predicate term

- Standard Form: subject – copula – predicate
- All millionaires are businessman
 - Some students are scholars
 - Gloria Macapagal Arroyo is the President

Quantity of Categorical Proposition

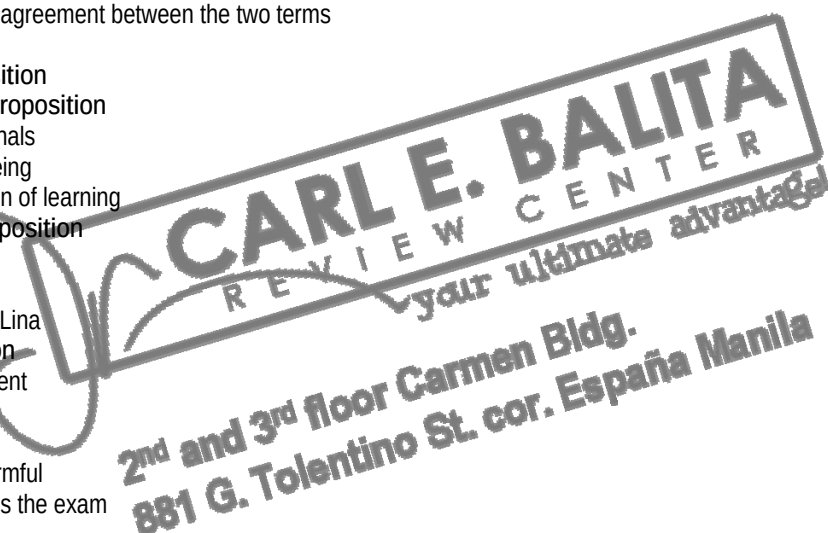
- Refers to the number of individuals to whom the subject term applies.
- Universal Proposition
- Particular Proposition

Quality of Categorical Proposition

- Is the relation established between two terms of the proposition
- **Affirmative proposition** – there is agreement between two terms
- **Negative proposition** – there is disagreement between the two terms

Four Standard Form of Categorical Proposition

- A - Universal/Singular Affirmative Proposition
- All teachers are professionals
 - Every man is a political being
 - A university is an institution of learning
- E - Universal/Singular Negative Proposition
- No man is an island
 - All men are not perfect
 - Jose is not younger than Lina
- I - Particular Affirmative Proposition
- Many students are intelligent
 - Some women are leaders
- O - Particular Negative Proposition
- Some bacteria are not harmful
 - Not all LET takers will pass the exam



FALLACY: A SEEMINGLY SOUND ARGUMENT

Fallacy refers to errors in the reasoning process or an argument that has insufficient evidence for its conclusion or simply the lack of sequence in the inferential thinking. Fallacies often involve the use of genuine truths that are distorted to serve the interest of the one employing them. We often encounter them in propaganda, sales talk, advertisements, and emotional speeches and in ordinary day today conversation with other people.

Since logic is concerned with right reasoning, it will be helpful for us to study fallacies in order to avoid committing them and becoming its victims

The Types of Fallacy of Relevance

1. *Argumentum ad Baculum or the Appeal to force*- this uses moral, psychological, cultural or physical pressure instead of reason in its argument. Appealing to force is wrong because it attacks the freedom of man.
Example: Since I am the boss, you must vote for my candidate or else I will fire you from your job.
2. *Argumentum ad misericordiam or the appeal to pity*- when compassion or pity is being used to obscure the issue.
Example: We should not fail poor students for they may not acquire the education that will help them overcome their poverty
3. *Argumentum ad autoritatem or the appeal to misplaced authority*-when the truth of the argument is solely based on an authority not relevant to the issue.
Example: According to Time Magazine, Filipinos should only have one child thus our congress must legislate such law
4. *Argumentum ad hominem*-when then personality of the opponent is attacked when it has nothing to do with the issue.
Example: Don't believe what Martha said on education, she was not even a graduate of PNU
5. *Argumentum ad ignorantiam or the appeal to ignorance*- when the truth or falsity of an issue is asserted because no one can offer proof of its contradictory.
Example: He was not guilty since no one saw him commit the crime.
6. *Argumentum ad populum or the appeal to people*-When the popular sentiments of the majority or those that counts are made the basis of the conclusion. This makes use of the bandwagon argument.
Example: Since milk from China causes health problems then we must avoid buying any product coming from China,
7. *Petitio Principii or Begging the question/ Circulus in probando or arguing in circles* -when one makes use of an unproven assumption to prove yet another assumption or the use of an unproven assumption to prove another assumption that proves the first assumption.
Example: Order is indispensable to justice because justice can be achieved only by means of social and legal order.
8. *Ignoratio elenchi or ignoring the issue*- when the issue is set aside and an unrelated fact is presented or an irrelevant conclusion is made.
Example: Question: Do you love me? Answer: Let us eat, you must be hungry
9. *Fallacy of false cause*-when an effect is attributed to an unrelated cause simply because the perceived effect took place after the perceived cause.
Example: We are poor because the government is not concerned with providing us the basic services
10. *Hasty Generalization*-When the argument concludes even if there is insufficient data to establish a valid sequence when what is true to a few is made true to all.
Example: Since I saw them together then they must be lovers
11. *Special pleading*-when the argument uses only favorable truths and disregards other truth that will not serve the purpose of the one arguing. When partial truths are presented as the whole truth.
Example: If you love your friend then you must be willing to give everything to him for love is giving everything without expecting anything.
12. *Black or white or the fallacy of broad disjunction*- when a contrary relation is presented as contradictory.
Example: Since you are not ugly, then you must be beautiful.
13. *Fallacy of accident*- when an accidental quality of a thing is assumed to be essential. When physical properties are mistaken to be the true nature of a being.
Example: Since ice is not liquid it therefore is not water

14. **A fortiori Fallacy**- when other properties/possibilities are not considered in arriving at a conclusion. The argument is based solely on one aspect of reality ignoring other aspects that greatly affect that reality.

A.3 FALLACY OF AMBIGUITY

1. **Fallacy of Equivocation**- when the meaning of a term is interpreted into two distinct meanings. When one of the terms in the syllogism is equivocal or analogous.
Example: Time heals all wounds. Time is money. Therefore, money heals all wounds.
2. **Fallacy of Amphiboly**- When a phrase or a proposition is used in two or more interpretations
Example: We must bear many children since we were commanded to go and multiply
3. **Fallacy of Accent or prosody**- when the context of a statement is falsely interpreted. When a statement is entirely taken out of context and the suppositions are wrong.
Example: Since Ateneo is located in Quezon City it must be called Ateneo de Quezon City and not Ateneo de Manila
4. **Fallacy of Composition**-When what should be understood to be the properties of an individual is taken collectively. When an individual characteristic is applied to all the members of the group.
Example: Fatima must be an excellent school since one of its graduates top the Medical Exam
5. **Fallacy of division**-When the collective property is applied to an individual. When what is true to a whole as a whole is made true to an individual part.
Example: Since teachers are responsible for their students, the teacher of a criminal must also be responsible for the criminal's act.
6. **Fallacy of false analogy**-when similarity of meanings is inferred from the similarity of patterns.
Example: Since both of us sir have the same attendance then we must have the same grade.

INDUCTION

Induction is a method of inference that proceeds from the relationships of particular truths towards a universal truth.

In reality, human knowledge started from the inductive process since what man experiences are particular realities and man will have to grasp first the particular truths of reality before he can abstract these to universal truths. From these universal truths man is able to further improve his knowledge of the particular as deduced from universal truths and principles.

The conclusions of induction are less probable and are a far cry from the certainty of the conclusions of deduction. However, the synthesis of the different human experiences and the body of human knowledge that has evolved and survived the test of time lends credit to the validity of the inductive process. This was further reinforced by the conclusions of deductive inferential thinking that validated and was often intertwined and has complemented the conclusions of inductive inferential thinking.

- **Analogy**- is a form of induction, which seeks to establish a conclusion on something that is yet unknown based on the similarities it has on a known thing.
- **Generalization**- is a form of induction, which seeks to establish a conclusion about a whole group or population based on a representative sample.
- **Causal Relation**-is a form of induction, which seeks to establish a conclusion based on the connection between a cause and its effect.

Type of Analogy Tests

1. Single Approach. Example: Fish: Shoal :: Swine: _____
2. Paired Approach. Example: Gynophobia: Women:: _____ : _____
3. Elimination Approach. Example: Eyes, Ears, Mouth, Nose, Feet
4. Number Series or Completion Approach. Example: Three, Twelve, Forty-eight, _____
5. Abstract Reasoning Approach. Example: ABCD, BCDE, CDEF, DEFG, _____

Note: The Key in answering analogy test is to determine the relationships that exist between and among the items and to complete the sentence.

Examples: A group of fish is a shoal as a group of swine is a drift. The answer to #1 is Drift

Eyes, ears, mouth and nose are found in the head while feet is not. *Feet is the answer to # 3.*

